local variables in the template.

The following code adds `method_missing` to a controller if the application is running in development mode. If the controller is called with an invalid action, this renders an inline template to display the action's name and a formatted version of the request parameters:

```
class SomeController < ApplicationController

  if RAILS_ENV == "development"
    def method_missing(name, *args)
      render(inline: %{
        <h2>Unknown action: #{name}</h2>
        Here are the request parameters:<br/>
        <%= debug(params) %> })
    end
  end
end
```

render(action: action_name)

Renders the template for a given action in this controller. Sometimes folks use the `:action` form of `render` when they should use redirects. See the discussion starting in *Redirects*, for why this is a bad idea.

```
def display_cart
  if @cart.empty?
    render(action: :index)
  else
    # ...
  end
end
```

Note that calling `render(:action...)` does not call the action method; it simply displays the template. If the template needs instance variables, these must be set up by the method that calls the `render` method.

Let's repeat this, because this is a mistake that beginners often make: calling `render(:action...)` does not invoke the action method. It simply renders that action's default template.

render(template: name, [locals: hash])